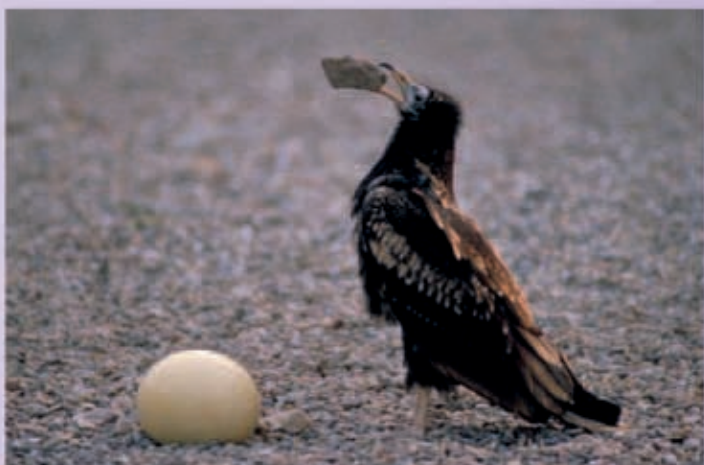




Tools of the trade

This Egyptian vulture has picked up a stone and is about to crack open an ostrich egg. This bird's habit of using stones to get at food is based on instinct. Many other birds are tool users and some are surprisingly inventive. New Caledonian crows pick up sticks in their beaks and use these tools to tweak insects out of logs. Some have even been seen making hooks from pieces of wire—behavior that shows these birds are capable of planning ahead.

Fox cub bites and wrestles in bout of play fighting



Learning and play

For many young mammals, play fighting is a way of practicing important survival skills and developing the physical fitness needed for hunting. These two-month-old fox cubs are full of energy and spend much of their time playing roughly together near their den. During these fights, the cubs learn how to assert themselves in their social group, with the winner becoming the dominant cub. The cubs also follow their parents on the hunt, learning how to steer clear of danger and how to make a successful kill.

